

TAB 6



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-267-22/23, **Version:** 1

Renaming of Christopher Columbus Middle School

June 6, 2023

Division of School Operations

Action Proposed:

Approve the renaming of Christopher Columbus Middle School to Canoga Park Middle School. This school is located in Board District 3, Region North.

Background:

In the Spring of 2022, the community of Canoga Park raised concerns with the current name of the school: Christopher Columbus Middle School. School administrators and staff began to communicate with stakeholders about the possible formation of a renaming committee made up of students, staff, and teachers. In the Fall of 2022, the renaming committee began to have formal meetings and generated feedback and ideas for school names from different stakeholders.

When the renaming committee received feedback from the community, the idea of including "Canoga Park" in the name of the school was an incredibly popular recommendation. There were also several stakeholders who wanted the school named after a modern "explorer", such as the school mascot. There was a small percentage of stakeholders who stated they would like to retain the current name.

The renaming committee proposed 5 school names for the community to vote on: Canoga Park Middle School, Canoga Community Middle School, Bessie Coleman Middle School, Ynez Mexia Middle School, and Christopher Columbus Middle School. Ynez Mexia (Botanist) and Bessie Coleman (Aviator) are modern "explorers" that our community proposed for the school to be named after. Stakeholders supported "Canoga Park Middle School" as a proposed school name. There is a lot of community pride in Canoga Park. Our feeder pattern includes Canoga Park Elementary School and Canoga Park High School. Renaming the school "Canoga Park Middle School," would be an additional source of pride for the community that could contribute to the legacy of Canoga Park.

Canoga Park was the homeland of Tongva and Chumash tribes for 8,000 years. Later, the area was part of the Mission San Fernando. Canoga Park was originally referred to as "Owensmouth" and was annexed into the city of Los Angeles in 1917. It is home to Canoga Park Elementary, Columbus Middle School Canoga Park High School, which are all close to Topanga Canyon Blvd. Sherman Way is home to many small businesses which bring unique character to the neighborhood. Canoga Park has approximately 60,000 residents.

Expected Outcomes:

The school and community voted to change the name Christopher Columbus Middle School to Canoga Park Middle School. With the adoption of this report by the Los Angeles Unified Board of Education, Canoga Park Middle School will become the new name of the school.

Board Options and Consequences:

If a “no” vote is rendered by the Board of Education, the name of the school will remain Christopher Columbus Middle School.

Policy Implications:

None.

Budget Impact:

Budget impact for the change will include an estimated \$5,000 for internal and external signage on campus. The school fund will cover the cost.

Student Impact:

Renaming the school to Canoga Park Middle School would have a positive community impact. It was also the most voted for name by the student stakeholder group. Students feel a strong, positive connection to the Canoga Park neighborhood and would feel connected to the proposed name, Canoga Park Middle School, rather than the current name, which is a distant historical figure.

Equity Impact:

Not applicable.

Issues and Analysis:

None.

Below is the breakdown of the voting that took place:

- Bessie Coleman Middle School: 48 votes - 9%
- Canoga Park Middle School: 245 votes - 49%
- Canoga Community Middle School: 91 votes - 18%
- Ynez Mexia Middle School: 42 votes - 8%
- Christopher Columbus Middle School: 89 votes - 17%

Attachments:

None.

Informatives:

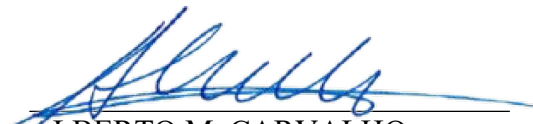
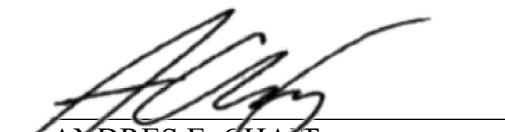
Not Applicable.

Submitted:

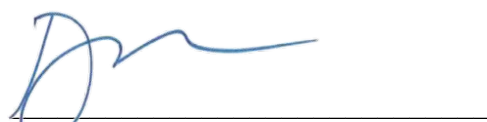
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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,

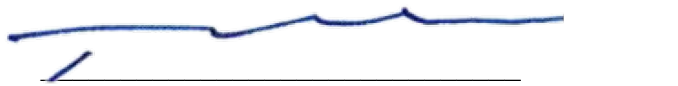
APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent
ANDRES E. CHAIT
Chief of Schools Operations
Division of School Operations

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel☒ Approved as to form.

REVIEWED BY:


TONY ATIENZA
Director, Budget Services and Financial Planning☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.